

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager driving agentic-first product experiences.*

Positioning, 13 years of product ownership, an active builder of multi-agent systems, and a direct track record turning AI automation into measurable user outcomes.

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§ WHY ZEELY

Zeely's goal is not to ship an AI assistant but to build a marketing agent that takes a business goal and executes autonomously, that is a meaningfully harder problem, and a more interesting one. The specific framing of the job description, agents that "determine next steps, use the right tools, and bring the user to the result", maps exactly to what I spent the construct8 and Rohde & Schwarz years working on: agentic workflows where the system takes the wheel. 2,000,000 small businesses using a product is also a feedback surface that makes discovery fast and iteration meaningful. *That is the scale at which product instincts sharpen fastest.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding assistance
- **Cursor / VS Code**, LLM-assisted development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research, summarisation, edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and rapid docs

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, built zero to one, solo.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides of the hire until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents across the full funnel so one person runs the day-to-day operation.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; agentic automation handling candidate qualification and matching.
 - Directly transferable to Zeely: same pattern of replacing manual marketing and operational work with an autonomous agent loop at scale.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ZEELY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow power users running Facebook and Instagram campaigns through Zeely, map the full workflow from brief to live creative, and identify where the agent currently drops context or hands control back unnecessarily.

WEEK 2

Slice the first workflow.

Pick the highest-friction handoff identified in week 1, most likely campaign setup or creative briefing, define a crisp success metric, and spec a minimal agentic scenario for engineering to build and test with real users.

Ship, measure, iterate.

Run the first agent experiment end-to-end, instrument adoption and task-completion rates, kill what does not move the metric, and open the next use case while feeding learnings back into memory and context design.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Zeely team,

Zeely's stated direction, building a marketing agent that receives a business goal and executes it autonomously rather than waiting for the user's next click, is exactly the product problem I find most compelling right now. Most "AI-powered" tools in the marketing space are glorified form generators. What you are building is categorically different: a system with its own decision layer. I want to work on that.

My most relevant recent work is at construct8, a two-sided staffing marketplace I built from scratch. The core product decision there was to replace manual coordination work, candidate qualification, matching, follow-up, with LLM agents running across the funnel, so that a single operator could manage what previously required a small team. The mechanics are identical to what Zeely is pursuing: define the task boundary clearly, give the agent the right tools, instrument the handoffs, and iterate on where it loses context. I ran that cycle alone, which means I understand both the product and the implementation deeply enough to work without a gap between PM intent and engineering execution.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, leading 15+ engineers and data scientists. The most instructive moment was an A/B test between two competing workflows: a polished UI-led experience and a developer-code-first path. The beautiful one recorded exactly zero clicks. That lesson, that the right agentic interface is often the one that gets out of the way entirely, is one I would bring directly to decisions about Zeely's agent UX surface in web, mobile and Slack.

At EMIL Group I rebuilt an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing engineers and client trust. I restructured it into three lean teams with dedicated leads; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure and we shipped the Claims Center from concept to production without a precedent to work from. I mention this because building the AI agent direction at Zeely is not only a product problem, it is also an organisational one, and I have navigated that before.

The SaaS and AI product experience, the hands-on agentic workflows background, and the data-driven experiment culture you list as requirements are all present in my track record. I would welcome a conversation about how I can contribute to Zeely's agentic-first roadmap.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of ownership across regulated industries, AI platforms, SaaS, and consumer-facing products. Recently focused on agentic workflows and LLM-driven automation, both as a builder and as a PM leading engineering teams. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user needs into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery at scale. Available at short notice, no visa requirements in the EU.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support, data-driven decision making.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, SDLC, GitOps rollout with ArgoCD, CI/CD, test automation.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Led the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme with 15+ engineers and data scientists. GitOps rollout via ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes; a data-driven workflow experiment increased pipeline runs by 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Owned a national labour-market analytics SaaS platform. Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt cutting data-update time by 75%, and led full containerisation and a large ETL migration simultaneously. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10%; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented the CGM hospital-system interface, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Rebuilt an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch time from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL & PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. Retail POS and forecourt systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE E-COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided marketplace with LLM agents across the full funnel; one operator runs the day-to-day. Anonymity-until-payment model; WhatsApp and Telegram as primary product surface; funnel analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-resistant encryption product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY & AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · ZEELY – AI ADMAKER

